

Jesus Heals Hurts and Betrayals

Communion Clears the Ground for What God Wants to Teach

Then I remembered how we began last year's meeting with communion. So He began to move on me.

He said, "Because I want them to judge themselves as much as possible for what He wants to teach, what He wants to bring forward."

I know His anointing will be here, especially in those teaching services, this blatant teaching. He wants to stretch your spirit. Believe me, He wants to change your life. He wants us to clear our ground and get everything out.

So I was getting ready to preach a two-part series on communion, to go ahead and receive the table tonight. Then He began to talk to me.

Foot washing is something that has pretty much been lost in the Church. Communion really does not save you. It is a remembrance of what did. Just like foot washing, the ceremony of either one will not do anything for you unless the significance of them is realized.

"This is My blood. This is My body."

Well, foot washing is never even brought up, much less preached on. When He revealed foot washing to me and its significance, it took forgiveness beyond anything I had experienced. It took the forgiveness I was able to walk in beyond the hurt stages and caused me to receive peace that I did not know a human being could actually receive in the face of being incredibly hurt.

I was in my back room praying because I had just been hurt. I had been hurt so badly I could hardly talk. In fact, it is kind of what is happening to me now. There are two things working in me: great, exceeding joy that makes me want to cry, and remembering what happened that made me want to cry.

Somebody had absolutely ripped my heart out and handed it to me on a platter. It took me a while to realize what the devil was doing. See, he did not want me to let anybody in on the inside anymore, because it is not your casual acquaintances that hurt you. How can a casual acquaintance hurt you? If you are really going to get hurt, they have to get in on the inside where they can tear a big hole.

After that was done and He had healed me, He was able to teach me quite a bit about staying healed and about another degree of peace.

So He wanted me to minister this, because you are going to have to get it out for God to have maximum. This week He does not exactly want to be in a deliverance mode. He wants you to be in a receiving mode, so He just wants you to get it out.

If I was going to be hurt too many more times, I just was not going to let people in anymore. It is a lot easier to put barriers up and not let anybody over onto your side of the fence. Just hold them at bay.

How many of you grew up next to your neighbors? I mean, you lived there twenty years, and you do not even know them. They run in their world and you run in yours.

He was able to teach me quite a bit about healing and the levels of peace that operate there.

Loving Jesus First Gives You the Material to Finish Your Tower

In this particular circumstance, I was grieving very, very intensely, because I loved this person just like my son. I loved him like my son. Well, he ripped my heart out, handed it to me on a platter, and I was grieving. It felt like I was grieving myself to death almost. My heart jumped up here, got stuck in my throat, and it hurt so badly I could not talk.

I was reading through John 13. I was going to open it up to you. I was reading through this chapter, and I had a vision, a supernatural visitation. Not only did God reveal to me what was in that chapter on foot washing, but He healed me at the same time.

He healed me, and He began to teach me.

If you are able, follow me closely.

In Luke, Jesus said:

If any man come to Me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and his own life also, he cannot be My disciple.

He said:

For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost?

In the natural, you are going to calculate cost right down to the very last nail, lest happily after you begin to build, you do not have enough material to finish.

All of those were one thought. They were one verse after another.

This is what He is saying: If any man comes to Me and hates not his father, his mother, his wife, his children, and his own life also, he cannot be My follower. If he does not pick his cross up and follow Me, he cannot be My disciple, My disciplined follower.

Then He says:

For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost?

This cost you are counting, whether you are going to have enough building material to finish your tower, is whether or not you choose Jesus.

If any man comes to Me and hates not his father, his mother, his wife, and his children, the word for hate means to love them less than Me. If you do not love them less than Him, you will not have enough building material to finish your tower.

The tower He was talking about is finishing saving your family. It is finishing your ministry. It is having the faith and material from God you need to finish your course on this earth.

The cost you are counting is not whether you are called or not. Who calls themselves? Your call was sovereign before the foundations of the world, when you were predestined to the adoption of sons. No, He called you before the foundations of the world. You did not call yourself.

So the cost you are counting is whether or not you should answer the call. I mean, did you call yourself? When was that your choice?

The cost you are counting is the material for finishing the tower. The cost you are counting is whether you are going to have the building material from God to win your family or lose them. To choose Jesus is to love them less than Him, because that is the only way you are going to get what you need from Him to see to their salvation. Otherwise, you will abort, because you will not have what it takes.

I asked Him, "Do You love You more than them?"

I said, "I love You more than them. I do."

I said, "But why?"

He said, "Really, son? You cannot love them more than yourself until you love Me more than them. Where do you think the building material comes from to love them the way you should, if not from Me? If you do not love Me more than them, you will follow them instead of Me. So how can you say you are My disciple when you are following somebody else?"

When somebody or something in your life is there in the place of Jesus, whether it be friend, wife, or children, and it is suddenly ripped away, it will leave such a vacuum. He is not there to fill it, and that is where grief comes from.

So what would I do, hypothetically speaking? I do not have to, because I am not going to lose them. I have the building material. But if my family did not make it back, what would I do tomorrow?

I would go on like I am today, loving Him and finishing my course.

When you love something more than Him--money, fame, life--if it is suddenly ripped away, He will not be there to fill it.

Jesus Becomes the Compensation That Leaves No Vacuum

This is what I was talking about when He healed me. When that man, whom I loved like a son and trained, tore my heart out and handed it to me on a platter, Jesus came and just absolutely healed me.

He gave me the understanding that until He is my compensation, He is all that I need in every situation, wherever I go and whatever happens to me. He is the only compensation.

I do not care if it is fifty years on the Amazon and I come out with one wadded dollar in my pocket and nobody ever even heard of me. He is all the compensation that I need.

In Matthew 19 and 20, He said:

The first shall be last, and the last shall be first.

Then He went into the parable where a certain steward went out and hired laborers. One worked clear to eleven hours, and one only worked one hour. The ones that worked eleven hours got exceedingly mad at the one that worked one hour.

He said, "Are you mad at Me because I have made you equal?"

Then He says:

The first shall be last, and the last shall be first: for many be called, but few chosen.

I used to be really confused about that parable, because I thought it was some kind of reward system by grace. But really, when He said, "The first shall be last, the last shall be first; many are called, but few are chosen," all that parable was signifying was the process by which you become chosen.

How do you know the guy would not have worked the one hour if he had to work eleven? How do you know he would not be complaining about the compensation like the man that worked the eleven? You do not know.

But what He was saying is this: "The first shall be last, the last shall be first." In other words, those who exalt themselves and make themselves first, they come in last. Those who make themselves last, the servants, they come in first.

"Many are called." This is the process by which you are chosen.

All those prosperity preachers, if you will allow me, that live for the money--not all do. Some of them preach prosperity to put this message to the ends of the earth. But at about the ninth hour, you lose your Lexus, you lose your house, and you lose everything. A guy gets mad and aborts. Why? Because the compensation is not good enough.

The process by which you are chosen is that He is your compensation. When He becomes it all and you choose Him, you have the building material to finish your tower, because there is nothing you can lose that He has not already replaced. There is no vacuum big enough that He cannot fill, because He is all that I need.

Letting People Close Again Requires Peace That Cannot Be Destroyed

The devil did not want me to let anybody on the inside anymore. Hold them at bay. The sin of familiarity. People have even written books on it: the sin of familiarity.

What? The sin of getting to know each other's faults and not being able to handle it? What are we talking about here? The sin of familiarity?

I did not agree with it. If you have to hold people at bay, what kind of fellowship is that? There is a certain bay, of course, but what kind of fellowship is that? Do you get past each other's worst? How can you become lifetime friends anyway?

In fact, He told me, "Son, in this life, if you can boast of just two or three lifetime friends, it is the best this life has to offer."

Those kinds of friends, they are everything. When I have friends like that--and I do--I do not care what kind of trouble they get in. There is no fortune I would not expend to get them out.

There was a man that was hurting the sheep one time. There was a certain time in my ministry when God had me in a grace period. He wanted to recover the man. That is why He sent him to me. I learned more about love when I was with him. I handled that situation differently.

He was hurting sheep, and I had to juggle the balance between how long and to what degree he was hurting sheep against his recovery. So one day, I was going a certain place, and God just came on me in my car and said, "The grace period is over."

But up until that time, several believers came to me and said, "When are you going to do something about him? When are you going to do something?"

My only answer was, "If you were in trouble and you did not know you were in trouble, would that be when you would want me to abandon you?"

I do not think so.

No matter how close you get to me, or I get to you, I can promise you, no one will ever stand in the position that Jesus has now taken. You can rip everything away, everything, and He is all the compensation I need. There will be no horrendous vacuum left, because He was already standing there. When it was all gone, He was still standing there.

If I love anything more than Him and it is ripped away, then I am left with the vacuum, and that is what destroys you.

When He healed me, I was able to begin to let people past the bay and on the inside.

Sometimes my wife would warn me, "They are going to do you in. They are going to do you in."

I said, "I know that. I know God sent them, so I am banking on doing them in before they do me in. I am banking that I will get them on the narrow path before they can get me on the broad path. If they try to destroy me, it will not work, because He is already all that I need. He has become my eleventh hour. He is my qualifier. I have passed. You can take it all. It does not matter to me. He is all that I need, and because He is, I happen to have the building material I need to deal with you. You cannot get ugly enough."

My wife says, "They are going to do you in."

One man did me in.

I said, "I know they have that potential."

"They are going to do you in."

I said, "I do not care. I would like them to be my friend. But if they do me in, guess who will come and restore what I got done in for?"

I do not walk in any fear like that. I would just absolutely forgive them.

Well, who did that for you?

A Betraying Friend Revealed Why No Person Can Safely Destroy Another

We are about to go through here, just for a couple of minutes.

This person loved me, and I loved him. He protected me. If I casually mentioned something, he would go get it. I mean, I did not do it for that. He would just go get it. Casually mention it, and he would go get it.

Have you had friends like that?

One day, he stepped between me and another person to protect me, because the other person was just kind of ordering me around: "Do this. Do that." It did not bother me much. I did not care. So what? I will do it if I want to. You may get saved or I will do it.

They were ordering me around, and finally my friend stepped up between me and them and said, "You show some respect."

Boy, I tell you, it got kind of critical there for a little bit. Then I thought, "Boy, he sure loves me, protecting me like that."

Well, it was not a year or so later that the same person was in my office telling me off. I got the same treatment. I got yelled at for about an hour.

When he left, I was grinning inside. I liked him as a friend, so you cannot take my humanity away. But I can tell you this: it left no vacuum.

When he left and God started ministering to me, He said, "Son, I am no respecter of persons. I love all My children the same."

So He said, "Take a lesson: if any person has the power to destroy another person, you are not safe around them, because they are all My children. I love every one of you. What makes you think they can destroy one of My children and let you go? Until they get mortified, they have that potential."

Sure enough, my turn came. But he did not destroy me, because Jesus had become my compensation. He was all that I needed.

It is a wonderful place to walk in. It is a place of peace and love. It is a place of casting your care.

When people can come into your life and mess you up and cause you to go into a critical mass--"I am not going to make it. Get them out of my life"--well, if that works on you, just as soon as you move them out of your life, the devil will move another one in.

I mean, I have had a long string of them. Move one out, move another one in. Is there a place on my back where you cannot find a knife?

That is why Jesus said, "You are in the world, but not of it." He said, "I have given you peace. In Me you have peace."

You are an extension of the kingdom of God, so act like it. The kingdom of God is not meat and drink, but righteousness, joy, and peace in the Holy Ghost.

If a person has the capacity to destroy you, and you have the capacity to be destroyed by them, then when they are done with you, they leave a wretched mess: nerves frazzled, your body's immune system dropped by a fourth, because you are an under-pressure little creature.

He leaves you, and you pick yourself up and say, "Thank God he is gone."

Then the next one reports for duty.

As long as it works, the devil is not going to quit sending them.

Do you know when I noticed they let up? It was when it did not affect me anymore. The devil goes, "Well, there is just no use sending any more."

That is right. You come into my camp, and I am betting I am going to win over you.

Casting Care Becomes the Missing Equation to Faith

I have a master's in casting my care. I have a PhD in casting my care. I am as graceful as a swan. I can run forward with those skinny legs and cast my care on the altar with more grace than--I believe it started to say any man in this generation, but I doubt that.

I can gracefully run up and cast my care and walk away. I am more developed at leaving it there now than I am at picking it back up. I used to get it after a day or two. I would get lonely, go get it, and bring it home.

No, I found the missing equation to faith: the ability to cast some horrendous care and problem over onto God and leave it there.

My master's, my PhD in peace is called David, Bill, and Steve. They put me through school. Are you listening to me?

I told God, "It is a good thing You never sleep, because You would not get any more if You did."

About two weeks later, God came into my room and woke me up and said, "I am going to give these boys back."

I said, "Oh no. You have got a problem. I am going back to sleep. They are Your problem."

"But I am going to sue you."

I said, "Oh, I would really think about that."

"Why?"

"Because I have a master's in casting my care over onto the Lord. If you sue me, you would become my care. I know how to march you right up to the throne, drop you off, and walk away. I know how to do it. If you are saved, you have had your last good night's sleep. If you are not saved, angels are going to--oh, you have made a mistake."

Well, I found out how to forgive. He is all the compensation that I need.

Tonight, when we judge ourselves in communion, it says if we judge ourselves, we would not be condemned to die of the same damnable things that the world dies of. We take account of our life, bring it under the blood, judge ourselves, and worship Him. We thank Him for healing us.

Jesus Washed the Filth of Betrayal From Judas' Feet

Let me go ahead and read this comment just a little.

They had just eaten Passover. Jesus' life was coming to an end in John 13:1, so He began the last part of His great substitution and identification journey that He made to the cross.

Just before He went, He had a foot washing service. He had a foot washing.

That prophecy was fulfilled in Psalm 41:

Mine own familiar friend, in whom I trusted, which did eat of my bread, hath lifted up his heel against me.

When He was betrayed by Judas, He called him His friend, His trusted friend. Sometimes we think Judas was always lurking in the shadows, that he was never in the inner circle. But Jesus called him His friend. He was.

It is one of these friends who get in the inner circle, rip your heart out, and hand it back to you on a platter. That is when it hurts the most.

But you can only be hurt as badly as the vacuum that it leaves when they are gone. If He becomes your everything, He is all the compensation that you need.

I remember Benny Hinn when this little boy--I think it was the last one--was born. I was watching the program where they cut away. He said he was holding the baby in his arms right after birth, and God asked him, "Benny, do you love Me more than him?"

He said, "Yes, God, You know that I do."

See, He was ensuring the building material for that boy's future.

He said, "Yes, Lord, You know that I do. You know that I do."

Then he made an unusual statement. He said, "At a certain point in your mortification, you just have to have God. God just has to come and help you. There is no more dying outside of the power of the Spirit. You make it to a certain place, and you just cannot go anymore. It has to be Him."

I found that out. I also found out it is not by will worship. My new nature has set me free from Satan's dominion. As long as I make that new nature available to the Holy Spirit and He enforces it, there is nothing--and again I say nothing--that has more power in my life than what Jesus has become to me.

I forgive you just like I know you forgive me. I am not saying I do not have any faults, but I am saying that I have a capacity to continue in God as a yielded vessel until He does with me what I want Him to do.

So Jesus was beginning His great substitution and identification. They had eaten the Passover, and He washed the feet of Judas. He washed the feet of this man who was about to betray Him.

The reason Judas betrayed Jesus is because in substitution, Jesus was guilty. He was guilty because He was becoming my sin. He stepped into my shoes to take the penalty I had coming. So He was guilty, and He had to be turned in. But only as my substitute. He was not guilty by virtue of doing those things Himself. He was only guilty because He stepped into my shoes and was approaching the time when He was going to take the full penalty that I had coming.

So Judas betrayed Him, all right. He was guilty, but only with respect to substitution and identification.

So Judas went and betrayed Him, and they came and arrested Him.

This is the vision I had when Jesus was washing Judas' feet. My heart hurt. My throat hurt. My feet were up on the desk, I was kicked back and praying, and I was hurting.

I had read through this chapter hundreds of times. Suddenly I had the vision while I was reading through communion. I saw Jesus down in a kneeling position, washing this man's feet. He had His hands down toward the basin. I could not see that part very well.

What I do remember was the look in Jesus' face as He was intently, with love, looking up into the man's face while He was washing his feet. He was looking like this, knowing that His trusted friend was about to betray Him.

Yet this was not according to the custom of that day, when a traveler would come and the servant of the household would come out and wash the dirt, the mud, and the things off their feet and sandals. That was done by the servant of the house.

To think that Jesus washed their feet. It was not a custom He was talking about. He said:

My trusted friend has lifted up his heel against Me.

That meant every step Judas took, as his heel parted from his sandal while he walked away from Jesus, was to Jesus' hurt. He lifted up his heel against Me, He said.

While He was very intently looking up into his face, I found out later that He was washing the filth of betrayal off Judas' feet in a supreme act of forgiveness.

He said, "If I be your Lord and Master, which I am--you have rightly spoken--and I have washed your feet, should you not wash one another's feet?"

In other words, "In a supreme act of forgiveness, I washed the filth of betrayal off Judas' feet. Should you not forgive each other your trespasses?"

It is those trusted friends I let on the inside who ripped my heart out. Yet when He healed me through these verses, this is what He said to me:

"In a supreme act of forgiveness, He washed the filth of betrayal off Judas' feet. When you forgive these people their supreme acts of hatred, harmful things they can do to you as no other person can--usually from the inside--no matter what they have done to hurt you, when you wash the filth of betrayal off their feet, then all the harm they meant for you will pass over you and come to rest on your substitute, Jesus, as He took the full penalty for that betrayal."

So you may want to hurt me, but you are not going to hurt me, because I know how to forgive you. The harm you meant for me has already been borne by Jesus, and it will come to rest on Him. He suffered under it, and I am the one who will go free, because I know how to forgive you.

You are not going to hurt me. It may look like you destroyed me, but watch real good, because I am going to get up. I am going to get up, and I will bet my bottom dollar that I am going to win you.

Follow me.

Is anybody having a good time?

John 13 Shows That Forgiveness Delivers the Betrayed One

Now, before the feast of the Passover, when Jesus knew that His hour was come, that He should depart out of this world unto the Father, having loved His own which were in the world, He loved them unto the end.

Supper being ended, the devil having now put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, to betray Him, Jesus, knowing that the Father had given all things into His hands, and that He was come from God and went to God, rose from supper, laid aside His garments, took a towel, and girded Himself.

After that He poured water into a basin and began to wash the disciples' feet, and to wipe them with the towel wherewith He was girded.

Then He came to Simon Peter. Of course, Simon Peter reacted the way you and I would.

Peter said to Him, "Lord, are You going to wash my feet?"

Jesus answered and said, "What I do you do not know now, Peter, but you shall know hereafter."

When He was resurrected and they were born again, they could understand spiritual things. He said, "You will understand. You do not know it now."

In other words, "This is not the custom of the house I am talking about. I know what you are thinking, Peter."

That is just like we would react.

"No, no, no, Jesus. You are not going to wash my feet. No, no. I want to wash Yours."

Peter said, "You are going to wash my feet?"

Jesus said, "You do not know what I am doing now, Peter, but later you will."

In the eighth verse, Peter said to Him, "You shall never wash my feet."

This next statement is what made me know it was part of substitution and identification. He said:

| If I wash thee not, thou hast no part with Me.

Simon Peter said to Him--and again he reacted like many of you would--"Lord, do not just stop with my feet. I want You to wash my whole body. Wash my hands and my head."

Jesus said, "He that is washed does not need it, save to wash his feet, but is clean every whit."

This is not about the custom of the day.

He said, "You are already clean in the aspect that I am ministering, but not all of you."

Because He was washing the filth of betrayal off Judas' feet, He said, "But not all of you."

That is when I saw the vision.

For He knew who should betray Him; therefore said He, Ye are not all clean.

So after He had washed their feet and taken His garment, He said again:

Know ye what I have done to you? Ye call Me Master and Lord: and ye say well; for so I am. If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; ye also ought to wash one another's feet.

If I, through a supreme act of forgiveness, washed the filth of betrayal off Judas' feet--I was being betrayed in your place--you should wash the filth of betrayal, through those supreme acts of forgiveness, off the feet of those who betray you.

All the harm they meant for you, all the destruction they wanted in your life, and all the hurt will pass over you and come to rest on Him who bore that betrayal in your place. If you can forgive them, you are the one who will go free, because Jesus paid the consequences for the betrayal.

Hello. I love my family too much for you to get me into strife.

I have got to say this again. I hesitate because I have said it so many times: I feel so much peace. You make it to peace, and life is good.

The thirteenth verse says:

Ye call Me Master and Lord: and ye say well; for so I am. If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; ye also ought to wash one another's feet. For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you. Verily, verily, I say unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord; neither he that is sent greater than he that sent him. If ye know these things, happy are ye if ye do them.

There is a big difference between joy, the fruit of the Spirit, and happiness, which is basically a fruit of circumstances. A big difference.

He says, "Happy is the man who knows these things and does them."

Why? Because the devil cannot keep you in prison.

I will still have joy if you throw me in prison for my testimony. I will have joy, but I will be happy when you get me out. Happiness can be a fruit of joy, and happiness is mainly the fruit of circumstances.

That peace can make happiness a fruit of joy, which means you could be in prison and you could be happy. Although it is very stringent on the sense man to have the happiness of the fruit of circumstances while he is being in prison and beaten every day.

But He said the man who knows these things is happy. Why? The devil sends all those people, and they rip your heart out and bind you. You get into hatreds and strife. Your life is controlled. You go from one prison to the other. There is no happiness.

When I found out the immune system drops by one-fourth when you get into hatred, strife, and pressure, why would I want that? At fifty-five, I feel better than I did when I was eighteen. At eighteen, I had headaches that put me down. Through my twenties, I had back problems that hurt real bad. I do not have anything that hurts now.

Happy is the man who knows these things and does them.

Does what? Keeps getting delivered from his prisons and walks above them. The devil cannot bind and control, because everything people try to do to you, all the harm and things, was already paid for and carried by Jesus.

Continually you are delivered. Continually he is a man who is happy, because his circumstances keep coming online time after time. The devil cannot penalize you, judge you, throw you in a prison, and keep you in it.

The seventeenth verse says:

| If ye know these things, happy are ye if ye do them.

I speak not unto you all. I know whom I have chosen, but that the Scripture may be fulfilled:

| He that eateth bread with Me hath lifted up his heel against Me.

"Now I tell you before it come, that, when it is come to pass, ye may believe that I am He."

After you understand all these things, when you are born again, you will know that I am He.

When he betrays Me unto you, you will know that it is truly Me.

| Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that receiveth whomsoever I send receiveth Me; and he that receiveth Me receiveth Him that sent Me.

Hallelujah.

Why don't you stand up?